

"My son, go and write a book whereby men will learn to fellowship with me as you do. Teach them to commune with me that I may lead them in their daily affairs of life. They have not yet understood themselves and their role in life. Tell them to bring their troubles, and they shall be washed away. Tell them to cry no more tears, for I dwell inside them and we are one. I know all things which are needed for their lives. Teach them to come to me so they may receive what I have for them."

In this book, *Divine Intimacy: The Believers Guide to Fellowship with God*, you'll find tools to transform your relationship with God, and you will be invited not only to read about him but also to become acquainted with him within ourselves. Scripture reminds us in John 10:27, "My sheep hear my voice, and another they will not follow."

Through the pages of *Divine Intimacy*, you'll discover:

- The higher nature inside every believer.
- The believers' oneness with God.
- How to understand the language of the Spirit of God.
- Constructing your life and plans by the voice of God.
- How to see in the Spirit.
- The Divine mystery of Christ within you.
- Christ-centered meditations for intimacy.



As you explore this book and apply the practices it offers, you'll experience a transformation in your relationship with God, and your perception of life and your mission.

JOSHUA MATTHEWS

JM

**DIVINE
INTIMACY**

DIVINE INTIMACY

**THE BELIEVERS GUIDE
TO FELLOWSHIP
WITH GOD**

JOSHUA MATTHEWS

JOSHUA MATTHEWS

Divine Intimacy

Copyright © 2024 by Joshua Matthews

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise without written permission from the publisher. It is illegal to copy this book, post it to a website, or distribute it by any other means without permission.

First edition

This book was professionally typeset on Reedsy.

Find out more at reedsy.com

Contents

<i>Acknowledgments</i>	iv
<i>Dedication</i>	vi
1 You Were Created for Love	1
2 The Great Deception & Fall of Mans Nature	5
3 The Path of Restoration	10
4 The Explosive Dimension of Intimacy	16
5 Practices for intimacy	20
6 Closing Prayer	29
<i>More books by the Author</i>	31

Acknowledgments

Firstly, I want to thank God for this opportunity, His Son Jesus Christ, and the Holy Spirit for taking me on such a great journey in this lifetime. I am genuinely happy and fulfilled daily by seeking and serving You, and You are the inspiration for all I do.

I am also grateful to my beloved wife, Grace Matthews, who sacrifices so much of her time for the work of the Lord alongside me, and to my two sons. They are God's gifts of love and co-laborers in the work of the Gospel. I want to express my heartfelt thanks for their amazing support throughout the process of writing this material.

I would also like to acknowledge my parents for bringing me into this world and giving me their best. My relationship with both of you has contributed greatly to my spiritual evolution, more than you may know.

I am blessed to also acknowledge my spiritual father, Stephen Jonathan Din (Emeritus), and his wife, Minyem Tania Din (Seer 1). You both have been an ongoing inspiration in my life and have greatly assisted me in my growth with God and in the formation of the ministry that the Lord has entrusted to me. I want to say thank you very much for pushing me and my family to higher heights.

You are one of the greatest blessings that God has given me in this life. It is my prayer that God grants you many rewards and that our love and work for the King of Kings and the Source of Creation will continue to grow stronger.

Thank you to all my Overcomers Global Network family for standing with the divine mandate of God as we raise the banner for Christ across all nations. You all are supremely blessed.

Dedication

I dedicate this book to God Almighty, the source of all wisdom, love, and light. To every man who reads it, this book is a gift from my spirit, born from the instruction of the One greater than all, given to me during my prayer time.

It is my heartfelt offering to all mankind and to my disciples around the world. I love you all deeply, and it is my prayer that this book becomes a beacon of light wherever you carry it.

I also dedicate this book to the weary and the lost, for within these pages, you will find your way back home to the Father.

May His grace guide you, His love strengthen you, and His presence draw you closer to Him with every word you read.

You Were Created for Love

There is one common truth that is often forgotten in this world: man was made for love, and man was made in the image of God's love. According to Scripture, man is made in the image and likeness of God: *"Then God said, 'Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over the cattle, over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth'"* (Genesis 1:26). And we understand that *"God is love, and he who abides in love abides in God, and God in him"* (1 John 4:16).

Many of you may be thinking, *"Prophet Joshua, what does this have to do with me becoming closer to God or intimate with the Lord?"* My answer to those people is this: can a tree grow without first being firmly planted in the soil? Or can man grow if he truly forgets who he was made to be? The answer is simply no. When man comes to the realization of his nature, that is when he will have the opportunity to grow.

Have you ever taken time to contemplate the beauty of your life? The way you can have experiences—you've seen some

being born and others die—it's like you're a foreign exchange student visiting from a very distant place. In life, we all must learn to speak a certain language. We've been given a body to experience the world, and even the breath of life, which is fascinating to me.

When you open the Bible to the book of Genesis, you read: *"And the Lord God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living being"* (Genesis 2:7). This scripture we have heard so many times, but today, I want to open your heart to a new perspective.

Visualize someone lying dead on the floor. A paramedic arrives to perform CPR on a complete stranger, breathing life into them. That person comes back to life, looks around, sees who brought them back, and gazes into the eyes of the one who gave them life. In their heart, they feel gratitude and say, *"As long as I live, I will seek to bring you some form of joy."* This is a common testimony from people who lost their breath and were resuscitated, according to studies.

Now consider God Almighty, who is the source of all creation. He is all-powerful and self-sufficient, needing no one and nothing else. Yet He chose to create man's body from the dust of the earth—not in the image of a pig or a goose, but in His own image. How beautiful is that?

Here's a quick fact: 21 elements found in the earth are also found in the human body. Together, they make up the medley of divergent molecules that combine to form our DNA, cells, tissues, and organs (National Institutes of Health). When God made your body, He knew exactly what He was doing. The image was correct, and He chose to breathe His life into Adam.

The amazing part of this creation story is that we are breathing the same life God breathed into the first man. All

of humanity has been given this gift. What is closer to you than your breath? What human body is alive without breath? None. God gave His greatest gift—Himself—living in us and animating us.

This is also part of the meaning of what the Master Jesus said: *“Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God”* (Matthew 4:4). The “word” here is symbolic of divine sustenance. In Hebrew, the word *ruach* (רוח)—meaning “breath” or “spirit”—represents the life of God. Jesus also said, *“The words that I speak to you are spirit, and they are life”* (John 6:63).

You see, we humans forget what God has truly done for us. God breathed the source of life into one man and gave it the ability, through our DNA structure, to be passed down to every person born into the world. Inside the breath of God is the very life of God, and it reveals His intimate plan for humanity. Men must live by His breath, which is the essence of God!

In other words, God gave man His life so we could live by Him, be sustained by Him, and have fellowship with Him. Through this, God allows us as young souls to grow to be just like Him.

I love the structure of life. For many of you, I understand this is new, but you must take your time to digest and assimilate these truths—not just reading for mental ascent or over-intellectual thinking. These truths are meant to bring you into a deeper realization of God’s love for you and His desire for intimacy with you.

Let’s take a moment to look at our natural parents. This may be a sensitive area for some and not for others. However, my intent is not to use personal experiences as a distraction but to bring clarity about higher workings in the systems of life.

When you think of a healthy or perfect mother and father,

what are the first three words that come to mind? For me, it is compassionate, loving, and kind. If you look at a newborn child, they instinctively seek closeness and love from their parents. When they do not receive it, they cry and can be deeply hurt by rejection.

Science shows that how a mother carries a pregnancy and her emotional state shortly after the baby is born are crucial. These factors impact the child's emotional and mental health.

Children of God, when we truly look at this reality we call life, it is impossible to say there is no love or that God wants nothing to do with us. That is a lie worked on by the evil one to ensnare men, which I will discuss in Chapter 2.

But for now, dear reader, I want you to truly reflect on how babies are designed to need the love of their fathers and mothers. A good parent naturally wants to nurture their child. How much more does our Heavenly Father, who gave us His breath, His image, and His DNA? He shared His life with us and even made an ecosystem on earth where we, along with all species, can thrive.

Child of God, you were made for love.

The Great Deception & Fall of Mans Nature

In the previous chapter, I spoke about many thought-provoking topics. I'm sure you are now awakening to the realization that God set the whole earth in order to show His great love. However, we must also recognize that, even with God's great plan, there is an adversary we know as Satan.

The definition of Satan is "accuser" or "someone with the ability to oppose." Many of us wrestle with the age-old question: *How can an all-loving God allow the chaos brought about by Satan, the adversary?*

I will speak plainly to you because it is now time for the generation of the sons of light to rise. The stumbling block of the enemy is deception. From the very beginning, Satan deceived humanity by twisting the truth.

Let us remember what Scripture tells us about Adam and Eve. They were deceived by the evil one who was inside the Garden—a place meant for fellowship with God. Instead, they yielded to an opposing impulse contrary to God's command. For thousands of years, people have hated Adam for making

one mistake, while we all make thousands of them.

Nevertheless, the question remains: *Why and when did evil enter the world?*

The Bible says:

"I form the light and create darkness, I make peace and create calamity; I, the Lord, do all these things" (Isaiah 45:7).

So, are you saying that God knew the devil would rebel and did nothing about it? The answer is both yes and no.

God knew the devil would rebel and cause great damage to mankind, but He also knew He would use Satan as a tool in His hand to perfect His children. Through overcoming Satan and all his wicked cohorts, God's children are shaped and refined.

God allows the law of duality—light and dark, negative and positive—because, without it, certain balances could not be achieved. Lucifer, Satan, and the fallen angels had a choice to continue serving God or to rebel. They chose rebellion. Yet in their rebellion, God already reacted and secured the victory in eternity by sending Himself in the form of Jesus Christ.

As Scripture says:

"For in Him dwells all the fullness of the Godhead bodily" (Colossians 2:9), and *"Having disarmed principalities and powers, He made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them in it"* (Colossians 2:15).

Satan and his fallen ones are on a leash. Their time and jurisdiction are limited, as it is written:

"Woe to the inhabitants of the earth and the sea! For the devil has come down to you, having great wrath, because he knows that he has a short time" (Revelation 12:12).

The stumbling block of the enemy is offering false love. He entices people with things that seem fulfilling but lead to emptiness and separation from God.

The enemy takes joy in keeping people from knowing who they are in God. As it is written:

"The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly" (John 10:10).

The enemy uses tools like pornography, alcoholism, partying, and fornication. He entices people with a false sense of love and acceptance, offering counterfeit compassion and security. This is evident in movements promoting harm to the unborn, confusion among children, and other distractions meant to pull you away from God.

Religion itself can become a trap, making people feel hopeless, shamed, and unworthy of God's love. But Scripture reminds us:

"And we know that all things work together for good to those who love God, to those who are the called according to His purpose" (Romans 8:28).

The stumbling block of the enemy is using trials and suffering to convince you that God has abandoned you.

Consider Job, a man established and righteous before God. The Bible says:

"Then the Lord said to Satan, 'Have you considered My servant Job, that there is none like him on the earth, a blameless and upright man, one who fears God and shuns evil?'" (Job 1:8).

God permitted Satan to test Job, saying:

"Behold, all that he has is in your power; only do not lay a hand on his person" (Job 1:12).

Job faced illness, poverty, and abandonment, yet his trial revealed his nature and need to remember who God truly is. Afterward, God restored Job, giving him double what he had before:

"And the Lord restored Job's losses when he prayed for his friends. Indeed, the Lord gave Job twice as much as he had before" (Job 42:10).

The stumbling block of the enemy is making you feel unworthy to approach God.

Finally, as we close this chapter, you must remove the stumbling block in your heart of not being good enough for God. You may feel like, *How can I go to God and speak to Him when I just fell into sin? I still have bad habits. My life is not right.*

Let me ask you a question: does a good father kill his child for not knowing how to do math, or does he teach the child? Surely, he teaches. If that is what your earthly father would do, how much more will your Heavenly Father?

God says to you now:

"I will never leave you nor forsake you" (Hebrews 13:5).

"Come to Me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest" (Matthew 11:28).

As I'm typing this page, I see a hand going through my heart with a hole in His wrist, reaching to grab hold of your heart through the pages of this book. He says with the most compassion, *"I am with you. I will never leave you or forsake you. Come to Me, come to Me, and I will cleanse you. I am here for the ones they call dirty, downtrodden, and unforgivable. I am here for the one that lost their parents. I am here for you, the reader of this book. Don't doubt Me; I am speaking to you. Receive My love and begin to come away with Me. No more doubt, no more worries about how you're going to pay your bills. Cast your cares upon Me, for I care for you" (1 Peter 5:7).*

"Look at the birds of the air, for they neither sow nor reap nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not of more value than they?" (Matthew 6:26).

Child of God, He is calling you into His arms. No more doubt,
no more fear. Run to Him and let His love transform your life.

The Path of Restoration

To obtain a great position for intimacy, you need to wear the full armor of God against the lies of the devil. As it is written:

“Finally, be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power. Put on the full armor of God, so that you can take your stand against the devil’s schemes. For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms. Therefore, put on the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you may be able to stand your ground, and after you have done everything, to stand. Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist, with the breastplate of righteousness in place, and with your feet fitted with the readiness that comes from the gospel of peace. In addition to all this, take up the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one. Take the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God” (Ephesians 6:10-17).

Out of this armor, I want to specifically speak about the helmet of salvation and how to wear it proudly. When you

are looking to have deep intimacy with God, one of the first things the enemy may whisper to you is, *“How do you know you are saved?”* He might even try to make you believe you have committed an unforgivable sin against the Holy Spirit.

These attacks are common. If you struggle with this, know that I did too in my younger years, as have many great leaders in the faith. I am glad to tell you there is hope for you.

The core issue of man is his sinful nature. We are corrupted from the first man, Adam, for it is written:

“Therefore, just as through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned. For if by the one man’s offense many died, much more the grace of God and the gift by the grace of the one Man, Jesus Christ, abounded to many” (Romans 5:12, 15).

Wait—read that again. Adam messed up man’s nature, and Christ came to correct it!

Do you know that when Christ came, He said He did not come to condemn but to give life?

“For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but that the world through Him might be saved” (John 3:17).

And the scriptures remind us that Christ came to heal the sick:

“Those who are well have no need of a physician, but those who are sick. I did not come to call the righteous, but sinners, to repentance” (Mark 2:17).

He sat at the table with sinners, just as a good father would. He spoke to people outcast from society, cleaned them up, and used them to change the world. As it is written:

“But God demonstrates His own love toward us, in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8).

God—the true, good, and perfect Father—is able to look past

our flaws and cover us from the wickedness of Satan. He gives us grace and time to walk as His children, growing more into His perfection. In fact, He gave us a promise that He would never leave us:

“For He Himself has said, ‘I will never leave you nor forsake you’” (Hebrews 13:5).

This is an amazing promise. Additionally, He promised to send His Holy Spirit, as written in Acts:

“And it shall come to pass in the last days, says God, that I will pour out My Spirit on all flesh; your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, your young men shall see visions, your old men shall dream dreams” (Acts 2:17).

He called all of us into repentance by the Word of the Gospel: to repent, believe, and accept that He saved us, died for us, and gave us eternal life.

Children of God, do not take this lightly! If we believe, we are saved. Not only that, but He said we shall receive access to the very throne of God:

“Let us therefore come boldly to the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy and find grace to help in time of need” (Hebrews 4:16).

He also promised the Holy Spirit for 24/7 guidance:

“However, when He, the Spirit of truth, has come, He will guide you into all truth; for He will not speak on His own authority, but whatever He hears He will speak; and He will tell you things to come” (John 16:13).

We have a promise of coming to the Father through the shed blood of Christ and the righteousness He gave to us as a gift:

“For He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us, that we might become the righteousness of God in Him” (2 Corinthians 5:21).

Now, with this clear foundation, how does one begin to get guidance and develop intimacy with God?

Here's the continuation of your text, refined for grammar, spelling, clarity, and flow, with the scriptures quoted as requested:

Now, with this clear foundation, how does one begin to get guidance and develop intimacy with God? According to the revelation given to me, there are principles we must follow to cultivate divine intimacy.

Principle 1: Understand Your Identity in Christ

The first principle is that you must have a basic understanding that you are a child of God, forgiven and divine. This identity is not something you earn; it is received through Christ. As it is written:

"But as many as received Him, to them He gave the right to become children of God, to those who believe in His name" (John 1:12).

You must know that you are no longer separated from God. You have been reconciled to Him. You have been made one with Him through Christ.

Principle 2: Faith and Oneness with Christ

The second principle is to follow the path of faith and oneness. You must have faith that you can come to God because of what Christ has done for you. Begin developing a mindset of oneness with Christ. Just as your body and breath cannot be separated, neither can you and God be separated.

You must train your mind to think like Christ. The Bible says: *"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is that good and acceptable and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).*

Jesus Himself declared, *"I and My Father are one"* (John 10:30). This is the mindset you must adopt: that God lives in you, delights in you, and has made you one with Him.

This revelation is what the Apostle Paul understood when he

said:

“For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come, nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord” (Romans 8:38-39).

Principle 3: Quiet Time with God

The next principle is one that I practice daily. Right now, I am over 60 days into a 100-day period of dedicated time with the Lord. This is something all great men and women of faith practice when they want to grow in the Lord.

You must begin to go away with God and pray quietly. You don’t need to scream. You don’t need to use flowery language. Be yourself—God knows who you are, and you don’t need to behave religiously to impress Him.

Jesus Christ practiced this principle while He was on the earth:

“So He Himself often withdrew into the wilderness and prayed” (Luke 5:16).

Elijah also practiced this principle:

“Then he went on alone into the wilderness, traveling all day. He sat down under a solitary broom tree and prayed that he might die. ‘I have had enough, Lord,’ he said” (1 Kings 19:4).

Moses, too, went to be alone with God:

“So Moses arose with his assistant Joshua, and Moses went up to the mountain of God” (Exodus 24:13).

This divine model is essential. If you desire intimacy with God, you must learn to spend time alone with Him.

Principle 4: Prayer

The next principle is prayer. This is what you do when you are alone with God. There are different types of prayer, such

as praying in the Spirit, thanksgiving prayers, and intercessory prayers. But for intimacy with God, you must be led by the Holy Spirit each time.

In the Scriptures, Elijah sought God's voice in specific ways:

"Then He said, 'Go out, and stand on the mountain before the Lord.' And behold, the Lord passed by, and a great and strong wind tore into the mountains and broke the rocks in pieces before the Lord, but the Lord was not in the wind; and after the wind an earthquake, but the Lord was not in the earthquake; and after the earthquake a fire, but the Lord was not in the fire; and after the fire a still small voice" (1 Kings 19:11-12).

You must approach prayer with an open heart, ready to receive however God chooses to speak that day.

For example, there is a type of prayer I call "listening prayer," where you quiet your mind and write down the emotions, thoughts, and visions that come to you. To begin, bring your mind to a relaxed state by breathing deeply and slowly. As you exhale, visualize your thoughts leaving your mind. Then, ask the Lord in your heart, *"Speak to me, Lord; I am listening."*

You must understand that God, angels, and spiritual beings communicate in ways beyond words. They speak through thoughts, emotions, and visions. As it is written:

"Then He dreamed, and behold, a ladder was set up on the earth, and its top reached to heaven; and there the angels of God were ascending and descending on it" (Genesis 28:12).

Many of us have experienced God's guidance through feelings or impressions. For example, you may ask God about someone, and suddenly, you feel a deep concern for them. Upon checking on them, you discover they were in a difficult situation. This is one of the many ways God can speak.

The Explosive Dimension of Intimacy

The more you exercise the principles from the previous chapter, along with the workbook practices designed to help you develop direct fellowship with the Spirit of God, you will find yourself naturally fellowshiping with Him throughout the day. What once felt like effort will become a joyful part of your life, an unbroken connection to God.

When I first started seeking God deeply, I had to learn everything from scratch—how to worship, what words to use beyond *hallelujah* and *amen*, how to pray prayers that please God, and how to meditate. Over time, I can truly say the scripture is true:

“Draw near to God and He will draw near to you” (James 4:8).

The more I kept coming to God with the little I had, the more He gave me in return. I started with just reading my Bible alone and not speaking in tongues. Then, one day during my study, I asked Him to give me the gift of speaking in tongues, and He did. I went from knowing only a few simple praise songs to learning and practicing worship until I began to receive original

songs for ministry.

Children of God, this is not about me, and I am not boasting in myself. I am here to testify to the life-changing power of sitting in His presence. Everything I lacked, He gave to me by His grace. When I acknowledged my wrongs before Him, He washed and delivered me, and He even equipped me to help others experience the same cleansing.

When I first began seeing visions and hearing God's voice, I was just a child. He would encourage me and help me see my life and the lives of others as He intended them to be. I share this to encourage you as you begin your journey of spending alone time with the Lord, practicing listening prayer, and contemplating the glorious power of the Holy Spirit. May heaven visit you, and may you go from one level of glory to another, in Jesus' name.

When I think about men like my spiritual father, Stephen Jonathan Din, I am reminded of the mighty work of God in the lives of those who cultivate deep intimacy with Him. My spiritual father avoided the traps of jealous people through the Spirit of God. When he prayed, the rain would stop. When he decreed something, it would happen. Gold dust would appear on people as he preached. Yet, other pastors said among themselves, *"Let us kill this man and set him up."*

The Lord spoke to my spiritual father in advance, telling him to leave the house where he was staying. God instructed him to act as though he was taking out the trash, leave the door open, buy a plane ticket, and return to his native country. My spiritual father obeyed, and the jealous men broke into the house intending to harm him, but they found no one there. This level of intimacy saved his life.

It is my prayer that you will be connected to the throne of

God 24/7, able to tune in like a radio, as it is written:

“My sheep hear My voice, and I know them, and they follow Me”
(John 10:27).

Another man whose life demonstrates the explosive dimension of intimacy with God is D.G.S. Dhinakaran. Known for his powerful encounters with the Lord, he often said that intimacy with God was not reserved for a select few—it was available to all who would seek Him. One remarkable story is when he prayed for someone with a terminal illness. He spent hours in prayer, asking God for clarity, and during this time, he saw a vision of Jesus placing His hand on the person. After praying according to the vision, the individual was miraculously healed. This was not a one-time occurrence but a reflection of his life of unbroken fellowship with God.

Similarly, Kathryn Kuhlman, a woman of extraordinary intimacy with the Holy Spirit, often said, *“I die a thousand deaths before every service.”* This reflected her complete surrender to the Lord. Her ministry was filled with miracles, from healings to transformations, but she always attributed it to the Holy Spirit working through her. One notable event occurred during a service when a paralyzed man stood up and walked without anyone laying hands on him. She would often remind people that the power came from the intimacy she had cultivated with the Spirit of God, saying, *“The Holy Spirit is more real to me than anyone else in this world.”*

As you journey deeper into intimacy with God, remember that the lives of these individuals are not exceptions. They are examples of what is possible when you pursue God wholeheartedly.

In conclusion, developing intimacy with God requires consistency, faith, and a willingness to surrender every part of your

life to Him. The path may not always be easy, but the rewards are eternal. God desires a relationship with you that is personal, transformative, and powerful.

May you never grow weary in your pursuit of Him. May you experience the joy of His presence, the clarity of His voice, and the power of His Spirit. And may you, like those who have gone before us, walk boldly in the explosive dimension of intimacy with God.

In Jesus' name, amen.

Practices for intimacy

We know those who are mature by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil. As it is written:

“But solid food belongs to those who are of full age, that is, those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil” (Hebrews 5:14).

The journey to intimacy with God requires practice, consistency, and faith. It is through these practices that we learn to discern His voice, understand His presence, and grow in fellowship with Him. In this chapter, I will guide you through exercises that will help you cultivate a deeper relationship with God.

These practices are not rigid rules but guidelines to help you grow in intimacy. Modify them as you see fit to meet your needs and situation. The most important thing is to be honest with God. Always start your prayers with thanksgiving, as it is written:

“Enter into His gates with thanksgiving, and into His courts with praise. Be thankful to Him, and bless His name” (Psalm 100:4).

As you engage in these exercises, begin a journal to document

your prayers, thoughts, and experiences. This will become a precious record of your journey with God.

Naked and Unashamed

In the Garden of Eden, Adam and Eve were naked and unashamed before God. This wasn't just about physical nudity—it symbolized their openness, vulnerability, and trust in God. As it is written:

“And they were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed” (Genesis 2:25).

Coming to God in intimacy requires the same vulnerability. Bring your pains, failures, joys, and fears to Him without hiding. God already knows everything about you, but He desires your surrender as a step of trust.

Prayer: Lord, I come to You as a step of faith.

Father, I surrender to You all my pain, my worries, and my fears. You are my Good Father, and I trust You with every part of me. I'm sorry for the mistakes I made today—the times I failed and fell short. Lord, I need Your support. Strengthen me where I am weak. Wash me clean and draw me closer to You. I believe You are with me, even now. Thank You for loving me and never leaving me. Amen.

Scripture for Reflection:

“Come to Me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).

After praying, spend time listening. Write in your journal any impressions, thoughts, or feelings that come to you.

Quiet Listening: Hearing God's Voice

Jesus said:

“My sheep hear My voice, and I know them, and they follow Me” (John 10:27).

This exercise focuses on quieting your heart to hear God's voice. It is not about striving but learning to rest in His presence

and recognize His gentle whispers.

Prayer: Lord, speak to me.

Father, I quiet my mind before You. I lay aside all distractions and worries. I am here to listen. Holy Spirit, guide me into Your truth. Open my heart to hear Your voice and to recognize when You are speaking. Thank You for being my Shepherd and leading me. I trust You completely. Speak, Lord; Your servant is listening. Amen.

Scripture for Reflection:

“Be still, and know that I am God” (Psalm 46:10).

After this prayer, spend five minutes in silence. Write down anything that comes to your heart—words, visions, or emotions. Even if it seems small, record it faithfully.

Contemplating God’s Goodness

Meditating on God’s goodness is a powerful way to draw closer to Him. Remembering His faithfulness in your life will fill you with gratitude and awe. As it is written:

“I will meditate on the glorious splendor of Your majesty, and on Your wondrous works” (Psalm 145:5).

Prayer: Lord, I remember Your goodness.

Father, I thank You for all You have done for me. You are so faithful. Even when I didn’t deserve it, You showed me mercy. I remember the times You carried me through storms, answered my prayers, and surrounded me with Your love. Thank You for always being with me. Help me to trust You more each day. Amen.

Scripture for Reflection:

“Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all His benefits” (Psalm 103:2).

Write down three things you are grateful for today. Reflect on how God has worked in your life and thank Him for His faithfulness.

Opening the Gift of Sight

God communicates in various ways, including visions. The gift of spiritual sight is not limited to a select few—it is available to all who seek Him with faith. As it is written:

“It shall come to pass in the last days, says God, that I will pour out of My Spirit on all flesh; your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, your young men shall see visions, your old men shall dream dreams” (Acts 2:17).

This exercise focuses on quieting your spirit to receive visions from the Lord.

Prayer: Lord, open my spiritual eyes.

Father, I come before You desiring to see as You see. Open my spiritual eyes so that I may perceive Your guidance, Your glory, and Your plans for my life. Remove any veil that clouds my vision and help me to focus on You alone. I trust You to reveal what I need to see. Thank You for this gift. In Jesus’ name, amen.

Scripture for Reflection:

“Then He said, ‘Hear now My words: If there is a prophet among you, I, the Lord, make Myself known to him in a vision; I speak to him in a dream’” (Numbers 12:6).

Spend time in quiet prayer and meditation, asking God to show you what He desires. Write down any impressions, images, or thoughts that come to your mind. This may happen immediately or gradually over time, so stay consistent in this practice.

Instructions for Journaling

1. Set Aside a Regular Time

- Choose a consistent time each day to spend alone with God. Whether it’s early morning or late at night, dedicate this time to Him.

1. Create a Quiet Space

- Find a place where you won't be distracted. Make it a sanctuary for your time with God.

1. Write Down Everything

- Record your prayers, thoughts, impressions, and what God reveals to you. Journaling helps you track your growth and reminds you of His faithfulness.

1. Be Patient

- Hearing God and growing in spiritual sensitivity takes time. Be patient with yourself and trust the process.

Building Your Life by Acknowledging the Lord

One of the greatest principles humanity needs to live a life of purpose and fulfillment is to acknowledge the Lord in all of our ways. The Bible teaches us:

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He shall direct your paths" (Proverbs 3:5-6).

When we surrender our plans, decisions, and desires to God, we open ourselves to His divine guidance. Jesus Himself modeled this perfectly, saying:

"Most assuredly, I say to you, the Son can do nothing of Himself,

but what He sees the Father do; for whatever He does, the Son also does in like manner” (John 5:19).

This exercise is a practice of building your life step by step with God, inviting His wisdom into every aspect of your journey. It involves intentionally seeking Him for specific direction and recording His guidance in a journal to create a roadmap for your days, weeks, and even years.

The Exercise: Weekly and Yearly Journaling for Divine Guidance

1. **Begin with Quiet Time**
2. Set aside time daily or weekly to sit quietly with the Lord. Start by praying:
 3. *“Lord, I acknowledge You in this moment. I surrender my plans, my thoughts, and my desires to You. Show me what You want for my life. Guide me with Your wisdom and love.”*
 4. After this prayer, wait silently. Be still and listen with your heart, paying attention to what the Holy Spirit reveals. This could come as a feeling, a vision, a thought, or a sudden idea that fills you with peace and clarity.
5. **Be Specific in Your Prayers**
6. When seeking guidance, be specific in your requests. For example:
 - If you are unsure about a career decision, ask: *“Lord, is this job the right path for me?”*
 - If you are facing financial struggles, pray: *“Father, how should I handle my debts? What steps should I take?”*
 - If you have strained relationships, ask: *“Lord, show me how to forgive or reconcile.”*

1. Specific prayers show intentionality and help you focus on hearing God's voice clearly for that situation.

2. **Journal What You Receive**

3. Write down everything that comes to your heart during your quiet time. This may include:

- Impressions or feelings (e.g., a sense of peace about a decision).
- Words, thoughts, or phrases that seem to stand out.
- Visions or mental images.
- Ideas or inspiration that feel divinely given.

1. Don't worry about whether it makes sense immediately. Over time, patterns and clarity will emerge as you journal consistently.

2. **Break Down Your Guidance into Weekly Goals**

- After each quiet time session, organize what you've received into actionable steps.
- For example: If God reveals that you need to work on forgiving someone, write down practical steps such as praying for that person, writing them a letter, or reaching out to reconcile.

1. Each week, review your journal and ask yourself:

2. *"What has God spoken to me this week, and how can I act on it?"*

3. **Create a Yearly Vision with God**

4. At the start of each year, take time to reflect on what God has spoken to you over the past months. Pray and ask Him for His plans for the year ahead. Write down specific areas

such as:

- Personal growth.
- Career or ministry.
- Family and relationships.
- Financial goals.
- Spiritual disciplines.

1. As the year progresses, revisit your vision regularly to ensure you're walking in alignment with His guidance.

Living by the Spirit's Guidance

Through this practice, you will begin to notice how God leads you in both big decisions and small daily steps. He may guide you to:

- Plan a trip or make a move.
- Pay off debts or sow seeds into someone's life.
- Heal relationships through forgiveness.
- Take bold steps in your career or ministry.

As it is written:

"For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, these are sons of God"
(Romans 8:14).

Remember, God's guidance may not always come in loud or dramatic ways. Often, it is the still, small voice, the quiet nudging of the Holy Spirit, that brings clarity and peace. As Elijah experienced:

"And after the earthquake a fire, but the Lord was not in the fire; and after the fire a still small voice" (1 Kings 19:12).

Co-Laboring with God

When you receive the guidance of the Holy Spirit and faithfully journal and act on it, you are co-laboring with God to build a life that reflects His will and purpose. This practice is not just a method—it's a way of life that aligns you with the divine plans He has for you.

As you begin this exercise, trust that God will reveal His heart to you. May your journal become a testimony of His faithfulness, and may your life be a reflection of His glory.

In Jesus' name, amen.

Intimacy with God is not achieved in a single moment but through consistent and intentional practices. These exercises are not just rituals—they are opportunities to draw closer to the One who created you, loves you, and desires fellowship with you.

As you embark on this journey, may you experience the overwhelming love of God, hear His voice clearly, and walk in His light. Remember, God is always near to those who seek Him.

In Jesus' name, amen. I have created a work book along with this book which will give more details on how this can be practiced year round.

Closing Prayer

Lord, I pray for everyone who reads this book.
May the eyes of their understanding be enlightened.
May they walk fearlessly on the path of light.
Let loneliness, doubt, and unbelief leave them completely.
May Psalm 23 be a banner over their lives.
I decree over each of you:
You will experience divine peace, love, and joy from this day
forward.
May your spiritual ears and eyes perceive more and more of
God's guidance and truth from today onward.
In Jesus' name, amen.

"The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want.
He makes me to lie down in green pastures;
He leads me beside the still waters.
He restores my soul;

DIVINE INTIMACY

He leads me in the paths of righteousness
For His name's sake.
Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death,
I will fear no evil;
For You are with me;
Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me.
You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies;
You anoint my head with oil;
My cup runs over.
Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me
All the days of my life;
And I will dwell in the house of the Lord
Forever.”

Psalm 23 (NKJV)

AMEN! AMEN! AMEN !

More books by the Author

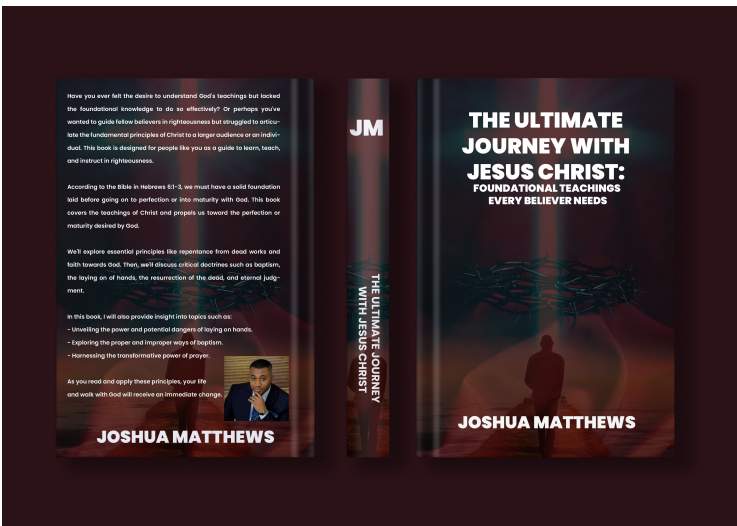
DIVINE INTIMACY

THE HOLY SPIRIT OUR ETERNAL HELPER

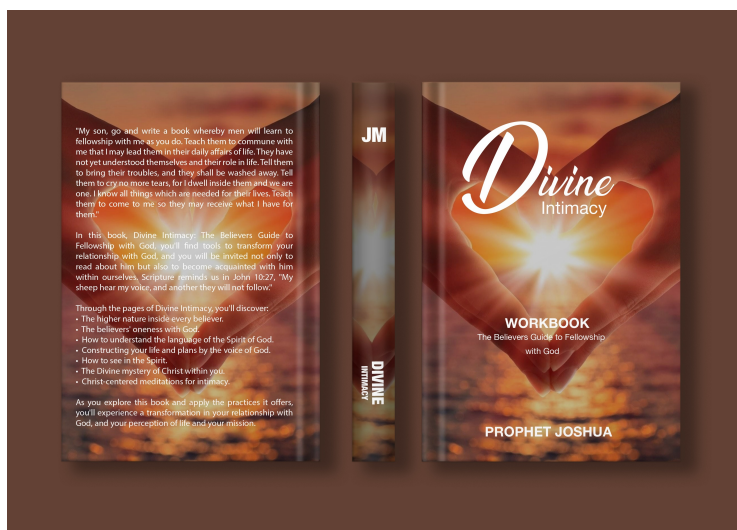


JOSHUA MATTHEWS

MORE BOOKS BY THE AUTHOR



DIVINE INTIMACY



EMAIL: joshuamattthewsministries@gmail.com to obtain your copies, or overcomersglobalnetwork.com to purchase.